



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

tathety uktvā sa pailūṣo jñānāyeśvaram ārcayat | BRP139.012.1

tatas tuṣṭo maheśāno jñānaṃ prādād dvijātaye | BRP139.012.2

prāptajñāno mahābuddhir gāthāḥ provāca muktidāḥ || 12 || BRP139.012.3

krodhas tu prathamam śatrur niśphalo dehanāśanaḥ | BRP139.013.1

jñānakhaḍgena taṃ chittvā paramam sukham āpnuyāt || 13 || BRP139.013.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 139: Pailūṣa's 'thirst' and the 'sword of knowledge' (Chapter 139), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

He directs his worship towards Īśvara, a name for the divine, yearning for true knowledge. The grace of Maheśāna, another name for the Great Lord, descends upon him, bestowing the very wisdom he craves. It's not just information he receives, but a profound understanding that sets him free. Emboldened by this new awareness, Pailūṣa then speaks forth verses that grant liberation to those who hear and understand.

The core of his message lies in identifying and overcoming the destructive force of anger. Anger is described as your primary enemy, a fruitless emotion that only leads to the ruin of the body – not just the physical body, but your entire being, your peace, your potential. It consumes you from within, offering nothing in return but pain and suffering. The key to liberation, then, is to wield the "sword of knowledge" to sever this destructive force. This isn't a literal sword, of course, but the power of discernment, the ability to see anger for what it truly is: a self-inflicted wound.

In modern life, anger manifests in countless ways: road rage, online arguments, workplace conflicts, and simmering resentments within families. We are constantly bombarded with stimuli that can trigger our anger response. Pailūṣa's teaching offers a powerful antidote. By cultivating self-awareness, you can recognize the early signs of anger arising within you. By understanding the futility of anger, you can choose a different path. You can choose to respond with compassion, understanding, or even simply silence. The "sword of knowledge" is readily available to you through mindfulness, meditation, and self-reflection. It is a tool to cut through the illusions that fuel your anger and lead you to lasting peace and happiness. The ultimate goal is to attain "paramam sukham," the highest bliss, which is achieved when anger no longer controls your actions and your reactions.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What are the subtle ways anger manifests in your daily life, and how can you begin to apply the "sword of knowledge" to these situations?